

MacIntelTosh Gets A New Meaning

A start-up called Parallels has introduced software that lets Macs run Windows and Mac OS X *simultaneously*. This is rather unlike Apple's Boot Camp software, which lets users boot their Intel-based Mac hardware in either Windows or Mac mode



There's TV At Home

A US company called Blue Coat is selling a service to businesses who are afraid employees will keep downloading football World Cup matches. Customers with Blue Coat SG appliances can "prevent the network impact of employees viewing FIFA World Cup Soccer."



Escape

WE KNOW WHO'LL WIN...

Brazil Vs Italy

Here's news you can use. Really. You can, with an 83 per cent chance of winning, bet that Brazil will beat Italy to win the World Cup. Of course, there's a disclaimer: if you lose, don't come complaining to us—approach Imran Fanaswala and Yashar Fasihnia of the American University at Sharjah. Fanaswala, by the way, is Indian.

What Fanaswala and Fasihnia have done is build an AI program that can predict the outcome of the FIFA World Cup. The program is called FIFI—standing for FIFA Intelligence. FIFI was developed by the two computer science students under the guidance of Prof Joachim Diederich, their project overseer. Apparently, this program was developed as a student project. They got an irrevocable A for their

efforts, whether or not their predictions come true.

The basis of the prediction is a statistical model: the two students went back 20 years and collected such information as past team performance, past scores, and so on.

The predictions are pretty detailed: one semi-final will feature the Netherlands and Italy, and the other will see England and Brazil. England will get there by beating old rivals Argentina. Germany will lose to The Netherlands in the quarter-finals.

There have been statistical tests, too, though we don't know what that involved; but according to the tests, the FIFI program has an accuracy of 83 per cent.

It seems to have been a rushed project: according to Fasihnia, if they had more time and manpower, "we

would have liked to research things like pitch condition, temperature, age of players, experience and many other variables. Then we could have been even more accurate."

FIFI, Fanaswala and Fasihnia have certainly made the news, partly because everyone is so eager to know who will win. If the predictions come true, the duo will almost certainly be in the news for quite a while. They will be called upon to predict all sorts of things, including the outcome of the forthcoming cricket world cup, whether or not George W Bush will get a third chance to ruin the environment, and the weather. They will be heroes. But it seems too good to be true: if AI really could predict such things, we'd have seen a lot more AI projects based on statistical analysis to predict a lot of

Whatever Happened To...

The Tablet PC

When Microsoft advertised Windows XP Tablet PC edition in 2002, we all thought that Tablets were the cat's meow. Pen-driven input had just started to become popular, so the idea of a full-powered PC that you could operate with a pen just had to work.

And to a respectable extent, it did—Tablet PCs have found remarkable popularity in healthcare and education, but analysts doom them to be stuck in such niches for a goodish bit now.

One of the main reasons behind this is the fact that Tablet PCs command a heftier price than their keyboarded counterparts. Then there's the possibility of mechanical failure, because touchscreen technology isn't as reliable as we'd all want it to be. Naturally, people wanted some security—something they've found in "convertibles" like Acer's TravelMate series, which plays the double role of a laptop and tablet PC. So even if the pen goes poof, there's the good old keyboard to fall back on.

Nobody's conceded defeat yet, so don't expect the tablet to fade away. Windows Vista will come with tablet support integrated, say Microsoft; perhaps that will help this wonderful idea get back on its feet.

Win! My Desktop

Avinasha S took it this month with his desktop living room! Here's how he did it: StarDock Object Desktop—DesktopX, plus widgets by StarDock

FoodObject By an Unknown source

Shutdown, Dustbin, Mailbox objects all made by himself

System Tray, Taskbar with object slider also made by himself

Ditto the background, created using Google SketchUp and modified in Macromedia Fireworks

Participate in this contest and win

**Wireless and Mobile
All-IP Networks**

by Yi-Bing Lin, Ai-Chun Pang

Published by  WILEY-INDIA



Send your desktop with description of how you made it to mydesktop@thinkdigit.com with the subject 'My Desktop' and tell us your postal address, too.